

Pimp My Gadget

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You've just bought yourself a shiny new mobile phone or you might have just assembled a new PC and we're sure you are happy with it.

But there is always a feeling deep down inside that something is missing, there is something that makes you feel that this new gadget or device is not completely yours. We believe you, this feeling is present in almost all of us – the need to personalise or customise everything we own. Be it a mobile phone, a computer or even something as small as a flash drive, we need it to be unique and different from the one owned by the average Joe. So what can you actually do to make your gadget more like you, well that's what we're here to tell you.

There are many things that you can customise, but what we're focusing on here, is all about our gadgets and other technology products. Even so, the few of us who admit to geekdom, will not shy away from wearing that attitude on t-shirts, shoes, etc. so there's a bit about that too along the way.

You must have heard of the show called 'Pimp my Ride', where all the bling is added to a person's car, well we're talking about

pimping your gadgets, read on to find out more.

The easiest thing to do for small handheld devices is to attach accessories to them. These could vary from small keychains or lanyards that can be attached to mobile phones. If you notice, most pen drives now days come with a small attachment option, you could easily use this to attach a lanyard of your choice, which makes the device different from the others available and at the same time makes it easy for you to identify.



Hello Kitty lanyards have become quite a craze these days

For mobile phones, another option is buying a funky external cover, but again, these are sold in bulk, so you might come across a random person with the same cover as you.

Other than mobile phones and flash drives, portable gaming devices such as the Nintendo DS and Sony Playstation

Portable (PSP) are becoming quite popular. Personalising these devices would definitely require a bit more than just key chains or lanyards. There are places where you can buy and replace the entire body of these devices. There are two uses for this, first you could save the original body from the usual rough handling and scratches and use it later, or do the reverse by using the device completely, and when bored change the body, which in both cases offers protection. To further customise a PSP or DS, there is something even better you could do – skin it. No, we don't mean peel the skin off your device, but instead, put on a fancy new skin that personifies your individuality. These skins are available in sticker format and are made specifically for these devices, so there's no cutting of any sorts needed, it's just a simple sticker, but looks great and you won't be able to know the difference. One might even think that it is the natural design of that device.



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TO SKIN A CAT

We had a word with Eshan P Paarekh, Director of SkinJam, and found out what it was all about.

Could you explain what SkinJam is to our readers?

SkinJam! Is about personalisation and protection of your gadgets. More gadget lovers will be amazed by the great concept of SkinJam's custom made high quality skin wrap service.

What made you bring this unique and interesting idea to the Indian market?

We thought that SkinJam is a very good idea for us because something like this has never been introduced in India. As it is a very creative thing to do and also helps people to personalise their gadgets.

What are the products that you have made skins for up until now?

We have done it on all kinds of cell phones,

laptops, PSP, cigarette lighters, and pen drives.

Do you give customers a chance to submit their own designs or is it always designs set by you and your staff?

We have more than 350 designs in our shop and the customers can select from that.

How much does SkinJam charge for this unique service?

We charge Rs. 700 – Rs. 1,000 for the cell phones and for PSP and laptops it is Rs. 1,800.

Can your skins be delivered to a person's home, where he can apply it to his gadget on his own, or will he have to visit your store?

We do not give the skins in hand to any customer. The customer will give us their gadget and take it back modified after 2-3 hours. We do the procedure in our shop.

Not only can you skin just the PSP and DS, but there are a range of devices such as mobile phones, mp3 players, video game consoles and even laptops. The web site www.decalgirl.com offers skins for specific products and the entire range is listed on their site. Again, there is a small chance that the same skin might be used by someone else, and you will lose out on the entire personal and unique look that you are going for. Well, don't be disheartened, decalgirl.com also offers customers a chance to get templates and design their own skins, but these templates can be used only for the products listed there. To take this one step further, there are some stores that offer even more personalisation by adding crystals and gems to gadgets. You might have seen some celebrities on the television walking with a